Mistry's reticence also became a drawback as, for a conglomerate as large as the Tata Group, it is necessary for the CEO or chairman to interact with the media. In all his four years at the helm, Mistry did not give even one interview to the press. In contrast, though Ratan was media-shy, he never missed an opportunity to articulate the group's interests in the press and other important fora. As *The Economist* wrote in the September 2016 article, 'Mr Tata regularly spoke up for his company and for Indian business, but his successor is retiring, inside the firm and out.'

Soonawala, who was most vocal in his support for Mistry when in the selection committee, discusses how Mistry even failed to implement what he had prescribed in the note he had submitted to the committee in October 2010 on what a chairman of Tata Sons should set store by. He says rather disappointedly, 'In all the four years he was there, he did not implement even a single one of them [Mistry's suggestions], not one.'

There were apprehensions too that Mistry was steering the Tata Group into businesses outside its core areas, such as the infrastructure sector, 'where bribes and other corruption could cause problems for the group's "clean" image', commented *Newsweek*. For a group that had always prided itself as an example of how business could be successfully run outside the swamp of crony capitalism, such a foray was seen as unnecessary and detrimental to its fiercely guarded reputation.

One of the more contentious issues that arose during Mistry's tenure was the acquisition of Welspun's alternative energy assets by Tata Power at a cost of $1.45 billion. Three aspects of this acquisition muddied the relationship between Mistry and his predecessor. The first was that it was Mistry's refrain that the Tata Group did not have a comfortable debt position. But if this was the case, the costly Welspun acquisition did not sit well with his position as it only added to the debt.

The second was that if Mistry could ignore the debt burden to purchase the energy assets, then there should have been no real compulsion to sell the Tata Steel UK and Indian Hotels assets at a loss. The reality was that the debt position was manageable. Mistry himself had opined so in an interview to the Tata website. An article by Bloomberg quoted him as saying that the aggregate debt was not something he was much 'concerned about'. For Tata Trusts, these positions were contradictory and irreconcilable.

The third and more serious issue was that the acquisition was made without bringing the proposal to the Tata Sons board for approval. This not